

Phishing Email Analysis and IOC Extraction Report

Project: Phishing Email Analysis and IOC Extraction Workflow

Case Study: Your Account Is on Hold

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Classification: Phishing Email

1. Executive Summary

This report analyzes a phishing email that impersonates Netflix by claiming the recipient's account has been suspended. The attacker attempts to create urgency using a fake billing notification while disguising the email as an official Netflix communication. The campaign relies on sender spoofing, brand impersonation, social engineering, and a malicious attachment to compromise users.

2. Scenario Overview

The phishing email claims that the recipient's Netflix account has been suspended due to a billing issue and requests immediate action to restore access. Instead of directing users to the official Netflix website, the attacker uses a suspicious attachment to hide the malicious payload and bypass traditional email security filters.

3. Phishing Techniques Identified

Spoofed Sender Identity

- The display name is **Netflix Billing**.
- The actual sender email belongs to an unrelated domain.
- The attacker impersonates Netflix to gain the recipient's trust.

Artificial Urgency

- The email claims that the Netflix account has been suspended.
- Users are pressured to act immediately to avoid losing account access.

Brand Impersonation

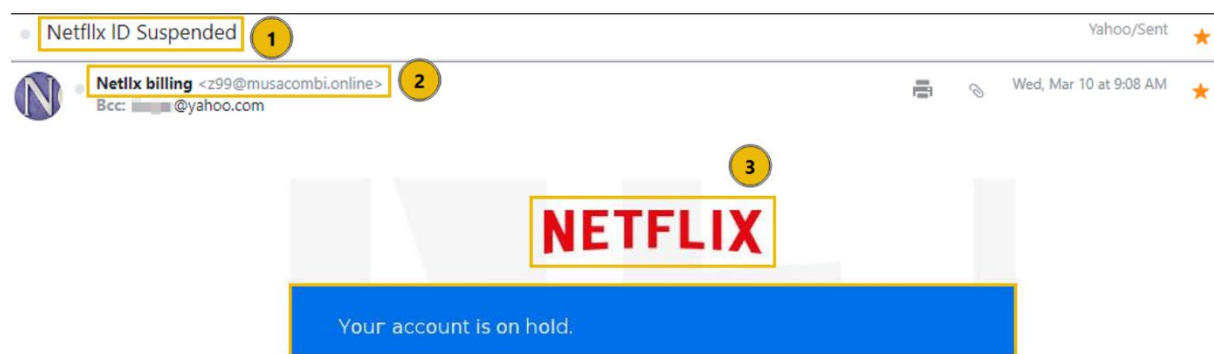
- The email uses Netflix logos, colours, and HTML formatting.
- These elements make the message appear authentic.

Poor Grammar and Typographical Errors

- Misspellings and grammatical mistakes are present.
- These errors are common indicators of phishing emails.

Malicious Attachment

- Instead of providing a direct login link, the attacker includes an attachment.
- The attachment may execute malicious code or redirect the victim to a fake login page.



4. Indicators of Compromise (IOCs)

IOC Type	Value
Display Name	Netflix Billing
Brand Used	Netflix
Sender Domain	Suspicious / non-Netflix Domain
Email Subject	Netflix ID Suspended
Attack Category	Phishing
Delivery Method	Email Attachment
Social Engineering	Account Suspension Notification

The diagram illustrates a phishing email and its components. On the left, a screenshot of the email body is shown. The email text includes: "Please update your payment details", "Hello Customer,", "We're having some trouble with your current billing information. Please open file [PDF] to update your account.", "Need help? We're here if you need it. Visit the Help Center or contact us now.", and "-Your friends at Netflix". Below the text is a dark grey box containing a "Questions? Call 007-803-321-2130" link, a "1" in a yellow circle, and a warning: "Please do not reply to this email, as we are unable to respond from this email address. If you need help or would like to contact us, please visit our Help Center at [help.netflix.com](\"http://help.netflix.com\")." Below this box is a "2" in a yellow circle. To the left of the email body is a PDF attachment icon labeled "Payment-up...pdf" and "155.7KB". To the right of the email body is a vertical grey bar. To the right of the bar, the text "Update Payment Account" is highlighted in a red box. Below this, the text "If you did not ask to reset your password you may want to review your [recent account access](\"#\") for any unusual activity." is shown. Below that, the text "We're here to help if you need it. Visit the [Help Center](\"#\") for more info or [contact us](\"#\")." is shown. Below that, the text "- Your friends at Netflix" is shown. At the bottom right, the text "PDF Attachment" is highlighted in a yellow box.

Please update your payment details

Hello Customer,

We're having some trouble with your current billing information. Please open file [PDF] to update your account.

Need help? We're here if you need it. Visit the Help Center or contact us now.

-Your friends at Netflix

Questions? Call 007-803-321-2130

1

Please do not reply to this email, as we are unable to respond from this email address. If you need help or would like to contact us, please visit our Help Center at help.netflix.com.

2

Email Body

Update Payment Account

If you did not ask to reset your password you may want to review your [recent account access](#) for any unusual activity.

We're here to help if you need it. Visit the [Help Center](#) for more info or [contact us](#).

- Your friends at Netflix

PDF Attachment

5. Analysis Findings

Subject Analysis

The subject line informs the recipient that their Netflix account has been suspended, creating urgency and encouraging immediate action.

Sender Analysis

Although the display name appears to represent Netflix, the underlying sender domain does not belong to Netflix, indicating sender spoofing.

Content Analysis

The email uses official Netflix branding and claims that billing issues have caused account suspension. This creates fear and pressures users into interacting with the email.

Attachment Analysis

The attachment serves as the primary attack vector. Opening it may:

- Execute malicious code
- Install malware
- Redirect users to phishing websites
- Steal login credentials

6. Detection Opportunities

- Detect suspicious attachment types.
- Scan attachments in a sandbox.
- Alert on brand impersonation.

7. Risk Assessment

Risk Level: High

Severity: High

Confidence: High

Category: Phishing / Malware Delivery

Reasons

- Netflix brand impersonation
- Sender email mismatch
- Artificial urgency
- Suspicious attachment
- Poor grammar and typographical errors
- Potential malware execution

8. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

Technique ID : T1566.001

Technique Name : Phishing: Spearphishing Attachment

The attacker delivers a malicious attachment through email to persuade the victim to open the file, potentially leading to malware execution or credential compromise.

9. Recommended Actions

1. Do not open the attachment.
2. Verify account status through the official Netflix website.
3. Block the sender's email address and domain.
4. Scan suspicious attachments in a sandbox environment.
5. Report the email to the security team.
6. Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) where supported.
7. Educate users about fake account suspension scams.

10. Conclusion

This email is a phishing attempt that impersonates Netflix to trick recipients into opening a malicious attachment. Multiple phishing indicators—including sender spoofing, brand impersonation, urgency-based social engineering, suspicious attachments, and poor grammar—confirm that the email should be classified as malicious and blocked.